

Planning the Task ahead

If you remember back in [Chapter 4](#) we discussed partitioning your hard disk. If you didn't read that part, to have a fuller understanding about what we're about to do with your hard disk, skip back and read it now.

WORDS OF CAUTION!

At this early point in the process of installation, be aware that you will be working with your hard disk in order to install Linux. You **MUST** make a backup of that data before starting. You do all of this at your own risk!

The main step with a Linux installation is to virtually 'slice' up your hard disk into partitions in order to put Linux onto it. This process is called partitioning.

You will not have to perform this step if you have chosen to use an additional new or recycled hard drive to install linux onto. Also, if you wish to simply delete the operating system (Windows/Mac OS) clean off your computer, then this step is also not necessary, otherwise, proceed forward!.